

Private Equity Accounting & Deal Structuring

Instructor:	Raymond Sterling, CPA	Term:	Summer/Fall 2026
Email:	rsterling@univ.edu	Dates:	May 27 – Sept 15, 2026
Office:	Cox School Building 140	Office Hours:	Mon / Wed 4:00 PM – 5:30 PM

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Examines the accounting, tax, and legal frameworks governing private equity funds, corporate restructurings, secondaries, and leveraged buyouts. Focuses on investment fund accounting and equity water-fall mechanics.

GRADING POLICY & WEIGHTS

Assessment Activity	Weight
In-Class Case Studies & Participation	10%
Transaction Deal Memos (3 Assignments)	30%
Accounting Problem Sets	10%
Exam 1 (Fund Accounting)	25%
Exam 2 (Deal Structuring)	25%

COURSE SCHEDULE

Date / Session	Topics, Assignments & Deadlines
May 27 (Wed)	Introduction to PE Fund Structures: LPs, GPs, and Commitments
June 3 (Wed)	Module 1: Fund Accounting Cycles, Capital Calls, and Distributions
June 8 (Mon)	Problem Set 1 Due: Capital Call Schedules
June 10 (Wed)	Module 1: Management Fees, Organizational Expenses, and NAV Calculations
June 17 (Wed)	DEAL MEMO 1 DUE: Primary Fund Valuation Analysis
June 24 (Wed)	Module 2: Distribution Waterfalls: European vs. American Style
July 1 (Wed)	Module 2: Clawback Provisions & Preferred Return Hurdle Layouts
July 6 (Mon)	Problem Set 2 Due: Tiered IRR Performance Layouts

Date / Session	Topics, Assignments & Deadlines
July 8 (Wed)	EXAM 1 (Fund Operations & Fee Mechanics)
July 15 (Wed)	Module 3: Accounting for Secondary Transactions & Portfolio Pricing
July 22 (Wed)	Module 3: Leveraged Buyout Tax Dynamics & Goodwill Allocations
July 27 (Mon)	DEAL MEMO 2 DUE: Secondary Portfolio Discount Assessment
July 29 (Wed)	Module 4: Debt Structural Subordination and Intercreditor Agreements
August 5 (Wed)	Module 4: Recapitalizations & Earn-Out Accounting Standards
August 12 (Wed)	Problem Set 3 Due: Asset Write-Up Adjustments
August 19 (Wed)	Module 5: Cross-Border Deal Structuring & Foreign Tax Considerations
August 26 (Wed)	DEAL MEMO 3 DUE: LBO Capital Structure Recommendation
September 2 (Wed)	Restructuring Case Study Defenses
September 9 (Wed)	Comprehensive Course Integration Session
September 15 (Tue)	EXAM 2 (Deal Engineering & Distribution Analysis, 1:00 PM – 4:00 PM)